7-Day South Indian Vegetarian Fat-Loss Meal Plan

A practical Tamil Nadu + Kerala vegetarian plan with separate workout-day and non-workout-day portions, designed around a busy software-engineering schedule.

Your starting profile

Age / gender	36 / Male	**Height**	5 ft 10 in (approx. 177.8 cm)	**Current weight**	77 kg
Target weight	70 kg	**Diet**	Vegetarian	**Regional style**	Tamil + Kerala
Activity / work	Mostly active; software engineer	**Allergies / dislikes**	None reported	**Weight-loss goal**	7 kg

1. Calorie & macro targets summary

Estimated BMR: approximately 1,706 kcal/day using the Mifflin-St Jeor equation. **Estimated TDEE:** approximately 2,645 kcal/day, assuming a moderately active multiplier of 1.55. This activity assumption should be adjusted if actual daily movement or training differs.

Target	Workout day	Non-workout day
Calories	Approx. 2,200 kcal	Approx. 2,000 kcal
Estimated deficit vs. TDEE	Approx. 445 kcal	Approx. 645 kcal
Protein	130 g	125 g
Carbohydrates	275 g	235 g
Fat	65 g	65 g

Expected pace: roughly 0.4–0.6 kg per week; a reasonable planning range for losing 7 kg is about 3–5 months. These are estimates, not guaranteed outcomes.

How to use the meal plan

Choose the **Workout Day** column on days you exercise and the **Non-Workout Day** column on rest or desk-bound days. Swap versions as your week changes; the weekday sequence does not need to be fixed. Rice and dal portions are cooked weights unless stated otherwise. The plan is vegetarian: no eggs, meat or fish. Dairy is included.

Portion and calorie note: Meal calories and protein vary with recipe, oil, paneer fat content, curd and serving size. The meal table is a practical framework, not a laboratory-verified 2,000/2,200-kcal menu. Measure ingredients and use nutrition labels to verify totals. Include substantial protein at each main meal; some days may need an additional measured portion of soy chunks, paneer, milk or curd to reach the protein target.

2. 7-day meal plan (Monday–Sunday)

All quantities are per person. Keep recipes home-style and moderate in oil; adjust spice and vegetables to preference.

Day	Meal	Workout day – dish & portion	Non-workout day – dish & portion
Monday – Tamil Nadu	**Breakfast**	4 idlis + 1.5 cups sambar + 200 ml toned milk	3 idlis + 1.5 cups sambar + 150 ml milk
	Lunch	1.5 cups rice + 1 cup keerai kootu + 150 g curd + 100 g beans poriyal	1 cup rice + 1 cup keerai kootu + 150 g curd + 100 g beans poriyal
	Snack	250 ml milk + 30 g roasted chana + 1 banana	200 ml buttermilk + 35 g roasted chana + 1 small guava
	Dinner	2 chapatis + curry made with 50 g dry soy chunks + 150 g curd	2 chapatis + curry made with 40 g dry soy chunks + 100 g curd
Tuesday – Kerala	**Breakfast**	3 medium appams + 1 cup cherupayar (green gram) curry + 200 ml milk	2 appams + 1 cup green gram curry + 150 ml milk
	Lunch	1.5 cups Kerala matta rice + 1 cup sambar + 150 g cabbage thoran + 150 g curd	1 cup matta rice + 1 cup sambar + 150 g cabbage thoran + 150 g curd
	Snack	200 g curd + 1 banana + 20 g roasted peanuts	200 g curd + 1 small apple
	Dinner	2 chapatis + 150 g paneer vegetable curry + cucumber salad	2 chapatis + 120 g paneer vegetable curry + cucumber salad
Wednesday – Tamil protein focus	**Breakfast**	3 pesarattu (green gram dosa) + 150 g curd + 1 glass milk	2 pesarattu + 150 g curd + 1 small glass milk
	Lunch	1.5 cups rice + 1 cup sambar + 150 g chow-chow kootu + 100 g beetroot poriyal	1 cup rice + 1 cup sambar + 150 g chow-chow kootu + 100 g beetroot poriyal
	Snack	40 g roasted chana + 250 ml milk + 1 banana	30 g roasted chana + 200 ml buttermilk + 1 guava
	Dinner	2 adai + 1 cup avial + 100 g curd	2 smaller adai + 1 cup avial + 100 g curd
Thursday – Kerala	**Breakfast**	3 idiyappams + 1 cup kadala curry + 200 ml milk	2 idiyappams + 1 cup kadala curry + 150 ml milk
	Lunch	1.5 cups matta rice + 1 cup parippu curry + 150 g avial + 150 g curd	1 cup matta rice + 1 cup parippu curry + 150 g avial + 150 g curd
	Snack	200 g curd + 30 g roasted chana + 1 banana	200 g curd + 25 g roasted chana
	Dinner	2 chapatis + 150 g paneer pepper masala + vegetable salad	2 chapatis + 120 g paneer pepper masala + vegetable salad
Friday – Tamil	**Breakfast**	3 medium ragi dosas + 1 cup sambar + 200 ml milk	2 ragi dosas + 1 cup sambar + 150 ml milk
	Lunch	1.5 cups rice + 1 cup keerai masiyal + 1 cup kootu + 150 g curd	1 cup rice + 1 cup keerai masiyal + 1 cup kootu + 150 g curd
	Snack	250 ml milk + 30 g roasted peanuts + 1 banana	200 ml buttermilk + 30 g roasted chana + 1 guava
	Dinner	2 dosas + curry made with 50 g dry soy chunks + 150 g curd	2 dosas + curry made with 40 g dry soy chunks + 100 g curd
Saturday – Tamil + Kerala	**Breakfast**	3 medium vegetable uthappams + 1 cup sambar + 200 ml milk	2 vegetable uthappams + 1 cup sambar + 150 ml milk

Day	Meal	Workout day – dish & portion	Non-workout day – dish & portion
	Lunch	1.5 cups matta rice + 1 cup kadala curry + 150 g beans thoran + 150 g curd	1 cup matta rice + 1 cup kadala curry + 150 g beans thoran + 150 g curd
	Snack	200 g curd + 30 g roasted chana + 1 banana	200 g curd + 25 g roasted chana + 1 small fruit
	Dinner	2 chapatis + 150 g paneer bhurji + vegetable soup	2 chapatis + 120 g paneer bhurji + vegetable soup
Sunday – Flexible traditional	**Breakfast**	4 idlis + 1.5 cups sambar + 200 ml milk	3 idlis + 1.5 cups sambar + 150 ml milk
	Lunch	1.5 cups homemade vegetable biryani + 150 g paneer raita + cucumber salad	1 cup homemade vegetable biryani + 150 g paneer raita + cucumber salad
	Snack	250 ml milk + 30 g roasted chana + 1 banana	200 ml buttermilk + 30 g roasted chana
	Dinner	2 adai + 1 cup avial + 150 g curd	2 smaller adai + 1 cup avial + 150 g curd

3. Desk-job & busy-schedule survival tips

1. Meal preparation

Prepare a sambar base for 2–3 days; batch-cook green gram and chickpeas; wash and chop vegetables; and portion paneer or soy-chunk curry in advance. Refrigerate promptly and reheat thoroughly.

2. Office-friendly snacks

Keep measured portions of roasted chana (30–40 g), peanuts (15–20 g), plain curd, buttermilk and whole fruit such as guava or apple. Limit frequent biscuits, mixture, chips and sugary tea.

3. Hydration

A starting guide is around 2.5–3 litres of fluids daily, adjusted for heat, sweating, body size and medical advice. Keep water at your desk; use unsweetened buttermilk occasionally. Limit sugary drinks and packaged juice.

4. Break up sitting time

Walk for about 5 minutes each hour when possible; take a 10–15 minute walk after lunch; and take calls while walking. Build step count gradually rather than forcing a target.

5. Prioritise vegetarian protein

Useful sources include soy chunks (about 50 g protein per 100 g dry), paneer (often 18–20 g per 100 g), cooked green gram (about 7 g per 100 g), cooked chickpeas (about 9 g per 100 g) and milk (about 3–3.5 g per 100 ml). Values vary by brand and preparation. Include a substantial protein source at each main meal.

4. Consistency rules

• Do not skip dinner simply because you missed a workout.

• On a missed-workout day, use the non-workout portions rather than trying to compensate by starving.

• After a larger meal, return to your normal plan at the next meal; avoid punishment or crash restriction.

• Weigh 3–4 mornings per week under similar conditions and compare weekly averages, not single readings.

• If the average does not trend down for 2–3 consecutive weeks, review portion accuracy, cooking oil, snacks and activity before making a small adjustment.

• Aim for 7–9 hours of sleep where possible.

5. Weight-loss milestones

Milestone	Weight	Change from start
Starting point	77 kg	—
Milestone 1	75 kg	–2 kg
Milestone 2	73 kg	–4 kg
Milestone 3	71 kg	–6 kg

Final goal	70 kg	–7 kg

Important nutrition and safety note

This is general nutrition education, not a diagnosis or a substitute for individual clinical care. Calorie and macro estimates depend on actual activity, recipes and food labels. If you have a medical condition, take regular medication, have a history of disordered eating, or experience unusual fatigue or other symptoms, consult a registered dietitian or qualified healthcare professional before following a calorie deficit. The stated protein targets may need individual adjustment.

Guiding principle: Consistency beats perfection. Choose the version that matches your actual activity that day and return to the routine at the next meal.